The Dhāraṇī for Pacifying Epidemic Disease

Toh 1017 · Derge Kangyur

The Dhāraṇī for Pacifying Epidemic Disease is a very brief protective incantation preserved in Tibetan translation, and its Sanskrit and Tibetan titles are known chiefly from its closing line, which names it after its purpose of calming epidemic illness. After paying homage to the Three Jewels and to the Buddha Amitābha, the text gives a short mantra that names the person to be protected and calls for the binding of fevers, including those that recur daily, every third day, every fourth day, and continually. It then gives a simple rite: the dhāraṇī is to be written down and tied around the neck, so that the wearer is freed from epidemic disease. It is Toh 1017 in the Kangyur, and it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the short spells and protective formulas gathered within the canon's collections of tantra and incantation.

Homage to the Three Jewels.
Homage to the noble Amitābha.

tadyathā ili meti meli hane suhane so-and-so jvara bandhāmi ekahikaṃ trihikaṃ caturcakaṃ nitya jvaraṃ svāhā

As for the rite: if one writes this and ties it around the neck, it frees one from epidemic disease.

The dhāraṇī for pacifying epidemic disease is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The Tibetan words rendered "so-and-so" are a placeholder for the name of the person being protected. The reciter inserts that name at this point in the dhāraṇī.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.